



TIPS & TRICKS



Using *tree* to better visualise the *src* tree structure

The *tree* command can be used to better visualise the source tree structure to get a holistic or bird's eye view of the *src* tree. This command basically shows a tree (like you typically see in the left hand side of Windows Explorer) of all the files and directories recursively. You can control how much depth you want it to show, whether to show only files or directories, how it should handle symlinks, etc. It has tons of options to visualise and help understand how the *src* of a big project is structured. It's a neat and handy tool when you are starting out on a new project.



Note: Please use your distro package manager to install *tree*.

—Deepak Shetty,
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Creating an ISO image of a CD

Here is a simple command that can create an ISO image of the contents of a disk in the drive.

```
cat /dev/hdc > example.iso
```

Here, *hdc* is the CD/DVD ROM drive of your computer and *example.iso* is the created ISO image of the disk.

—Vishnu N.K.,
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What does your cow say?

Cowsay generates an ASCII picture of a cow saying something provided by the user. So does this cow also think? Yes, both Cowsay and Cowthink are the same cow! It is the most configurable speaking/thinking cow.

To use Cowsay, you need to install it using the following command:

```
$ sudo apt-get install cowsay
```

Now run the commands below to see the output:

```
$ cowsay Linux
```

```
< Linux >
```

```
-----
```

```
  \   ^__^
   \  (oo)\_______
      (__)\       )\/\
         ||----w |
         ||     ||
```

```
$ date | xargs cowthink
```

```
( Thu Feb 20 20:10:45 IST 2014 )
```

```
-----
```

```
  \   ^__^
   \  (oo)\_______
      (__)\       )\/\
         ||----w |
         ||     ||
```

—Rahul Bedarkar,
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Hard disk health check-up

It always helps to know in advance about problems that could crop up in the near future. Here is a tip that allows you to do a hard disk health check-up that can even indicate potential disk failure.

```
#smartctl -a /dev/sda
```

The above command gives you the details of the hard disk drive. To know the health status of a disk, run the